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A critical study of the portrayal of satire in Khushwant Singh's selected novels

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Abstract

It is said that forgiveness is divine and error is human. This adage is widely acknowledged. There are, however, certain exceptions. What would happen if someone continued making mistakes throughout? Is it possible to forgive him forever? At least he should be made aware of his foolishness, even if he is not punished harshly. Making fun of and laughing at him is one of the best methods to help him realize how weak he is. We call this strategy satire. Although the paper centers on satire, which is a well-known characteristic of Khushwant Singh's fictional works, it will also go into great detail about the social issues and problems, superstitious beliefs, the initiation of young minds into sex, jealousy, and discrimination—all of which are the primary things that Khushwant Singh criticizes in his writing. His writing style clearly reflects this. In order to portray characters in a striking and distinctive manner, Kushwant Singh has embraced the concepts of archetypes, mythologies, and stream of consciousness. The distinctiveness and style of Kushwant Singh's work are revealed by this analysis of him as a novelist and writer, and he effectively demonstrates the method of examination in all of his major novels. While all Indo-Anglican authors have explored a range of topics in their works, Kushwant Singh has focused on love and sex, depicting the hero's sexual interactions with women in both India and the United States in great detail. He describes the incidents and events in an evasive and straightforward manner.

Keywords: Kushwant Singh, partition, India, Journalist, partition of India, Indian literature

1. Introductions

Kushwant Singh's major novels frequently provide readers with information and explore topics such as the Quit India Movement and its effects on society, the social, political, and cultural life of the Sikh community in Delhi, love and sex, the hero Mohan Kumar's sexual relationship with his wife Sonu, and the company of women in India and New York. Kushwant Singh is introduced as a significant 20th-century novelist and writer. This is seen by the excellent way he presents his views in all of his major novels across a variety of important issues. Born in Hadali, a tiny hamlet in present-day Pakistan, on August 14, 1915, Kushwant Singh was a well-known Indian writer, journalist, and attorney. He came from a Sikh family that was well-known for its administrative and military support of the British Raj. After completing his studies at Government College in Lahore, Singh went on to King's College in London to obtain a legal degree. He started out as a lawyer in Lahore before switching to journalism and working for a number of well-known magazines, such as The Hindustan Times, The National Herald, and The Illustrated Weekly of India. Kushwant Singh gained recognition as a writer for his diverse literary works in a number of disciplines. He authored a large number of non-fiction essay collections, short tales, and novels. His writings were distinguished by their satire, wit, and open examination of contentious subjects. With the release of his debut book, "The Mark of Vishnu and Other Stories," in 1950, Singh's writing career took off. He went on to create other outstanding novels, notably "Train to Pakistan" (1956), which portrayed the human tragedy and communal bloodshed during the partition of India. The book is regarded as one of his most important creations and demonstrates his skill at fusing gripping narrative with historical events. In addition to his novels, Singh achieved notoriety for his collections of short tales, such as "I Shall Not Hear the Nightingale" (1959) and "The Portrait of a Lady" (1995). His short stories frequently explored the intricacies of interpersonal relationships, cultural expectations, and the difficulties people encounter in the evolving post-independence Indian landscape. Kushwant Singh's non-fiction writings, such as "A History of the Sikhs" (1963), demonstrated his

extensive research and understanding of Sikh history and culture in addition to his fiction. In addition, he wrote a number of autobiographical books, such as "Truth, Love, and a Little Malice" (2002), in which he openly discussed his own experiences, meetings, and thoughts. Kushwant Singh's writing was distinguished by its straightforwardness, vivid imagery, and unafraid handling of delicate and taboo issues. His use of satire and comedy gave his writings a unique taste that made them interesting and thought-provoking for readers. Singh received many honors and distinctions over his career, including the Padma Vibhushan in 2007 for his contributions to journalism and writing, which is India's second-highest civilian award. One of India's greatest literary awards, the Sahitya Akademi Fellowship, was also given to him. After passing away on March 20, 2014, Kushwant Singh left behind a rich literary legacy that still enthralls and inspires readers today. His writings are still relevant today and demonstrate his deep comprehension of social dynamics, human nature, and the intricacies of Indian civilization.

2. Objective of the study

- To find the Critical Study of the Portrayal of Satire in Khushwant Singh's Selected Novels
- To critically examine the thematic and social implications of Khushwant Singh's novels.

3. Review of the Literature

A literature review examines earlier research on a given subject. Scholarly research papers, articles, books, etc. are referred to by this name. A literature review gives readers or researchers a broad overview of the body of knowledge already available on the subject. As a researcher, I have done all in my power to gather knowledge that will help me answer the most pressing research problems. Numerous books, journals, and research articles that is helpful. Completed and unfinished theses, as well as articles, have been thoroughly examined. The influence of Kushwant Singh on Indian literature is extensive and significant. As one of India's most renowned and significant authors, he left a lasting impact. Indian literature has been greatly influenced by a number of his contributions and areas of work: Hamid (2022) tries to show that Singh primarily focuses on topics such as false religion, sexuality, man's avarice, hunger for wealth and power, the insanity of Western culture, and inhumanity. Khushwant Singh's "Karma" from Midha (2021) eloquently illustrates the copying mindset of the Western-educated Indian to demonstrate how colonial ideology shaped a native Indian's identity and how Indian cultural and linguistic traditions have been obliterated and replaced with western ethos. Khushwant Singh, a king of kings, is examined by Rajendran, Rajeshkannan, and Bavani (2020), who highlight his key partition themes and demonstrate his versatility as an Indian writer of English fiction. Jakhar (2019) finds that Khushwant Singh opposes a variety of unusual beliefs and practices, including crystal gazing. He rejects the hardline notion of Hindu Rashtra because it would lead to real disputes between Indians. Khushwant Singh's use of satire in his short stories is examined by Barman (2015). It demonstrates that the author, by using satirical weaponry, harbors the vices, sins, foolishness, and excesses that unapologetically stalk the Indian socio-political and cultural landscape. According to Nimavata (2014), "Khushwant

Nama" has sixteen chapters covering a wide range of subjects, including writing, journalism, health advice, poets and poetry, religion, Gandhiji, death, and humor. The strain that throughout the book is his openness and his interpretation of every facet of life, even though there are no logical sequences.

4. Methodology

- To obtain a thorough understanding of Khushwant Singh's novels, a careful examination of pertinent critical publications, periodicals, journals, and literary essays will be made.
- Reading reliable texts and dictionaries to prevent plagiarism and provide consistency for challenging spellings.
- Research sites, e-journals, web-references, unpublished theses, and web indexes will be helpful for advanced information. Dictionaries help researchers overcome obstacles throughout their studies.
- Through examining the literary content found in Khushwant Singh's books. To learn more about Khushwant Singh's life and activities, a thorough examination of his biographical references will be conducted.
- By looking at several English-language newspaper articles from both India and beyond. In the literary realm, English newspapers and literary reviews are also quite important. To learn more about Khushwant Singh, these periodicals would be useful.
- Research will benefit from visiting libraries, advanced study centers, virtual libraries, and web search engines, and it will be authenticated using these accessible sources. Since libraries have a wealth of scholarly publications and dissertations, they are also excellent resources for research projects.

5. Characterization and Human Relationships

Storyteller Kushwant Singh was renowned for his skillfully developed characters and their complex interpersonal ties. His writings frequently highlighted the intricacies of interpersonal relationships and human nature. The following are some salient features of Singh's literary portrayals and characterizations of human relationships:

- **Multidimensional Characters:** Singh's characters were vividly drawn, with a focus on their inner conflicts and complexities. Whether protagonists or supporting characters, they were portrayed as multi-faceted individuals with strengths, weaknesses, and personal dilemmas. This depth added authenticity to his stories, making the characters relatable and memorable.
- **Emotional Analysis:** Singh was skilled at capturing human emotions in his characters and had a deep awareness of them. Readers were able to empathize with the characters because of the nuanced depictions of love, fear, longing, joy, and grief.
- **Realistic and Flawed Protagonists:** Singh frequently used flawed characters who had to deal with moral quandaries. They were more relevant and human because of their flaws, which allowed readers to identify with their decisions and hardships.
- **Interpersonal Conflicts:** Singh expertly constructed scenarios that resulted in interpersonal disputes, exposing his characters' actual natures. Throughout the

stories, these tensions acted as stimulants for character development.

- **Generational Differences:** He also explored the divergent perspectives of several generations in his writings. He investigated the shifting views and values in Indian society through generational conflicts.
- **Cross-Cultural Relationships:** Singh occasionally discussed cross-cultural relationships in his writings, emphasizing the difficulties and beauty of bonds forged across cultural boundaries.

6. Legacy and Contributions

To this day, the question of man's origin is still up for debate. According to science and reason, some people believe that humans sprang from single-celled organisms. From a philosophical standpoint, God created man, and happiness is the primary motivation behind God's creation. But are all men content and content? If so, why is he engaging in undesirable, antisocial behaviors that others find inappropriate? And if man believes that happiness is the ultimate purpose of God's creation, how can he achieve it? He should undoubtedly change and be challenged. Otherwise, he will be held accountable in one way or another. Although it is true that everyone makes mistakes, this fact shouldn't be taken for granted. One should constantly make an effort to correct their mistakes. Otherwise, events may cause a change. Furthermore, it would be more effective if the situation took the shape of a man. In today's fiercely competitive environment, everyone has turned materialistic and greedy. The term 'sharing' has become meaningless. They demand more as they gain more. They go the incorrect route in an attempt to obtain more, which ultimately proves disastrous.

Satirists entered the modern world to make mankind realize their mistakes. With the intention of changing men, they just make fun of or laugh at society rather than preaching, debating, or engaging in combat. According to the renowned English poet Dryden, the ultimate goal of satire is to rectify vices. Therefore, the genre of satire is tasked with making fun of sin or foolishness whenever it is evident. It was widely employed by Charles Dickens and Bernard Shaw in their writings to highlight societal ills. Even though it became the most sought-after literary form in the west, Indian writers in English successfully used it to make fun of society and its elements and to raise awareness and encourage reform. Among these authors, former journalist Khushwant Singh began writing sarcastic pieces. There are satirical overtones in all of his works.

Khushwant Singh is a sensitive novelist who addresses societal challenges and difficulties, and his works show this social concern. His novels are characterized by a hint of humanity. As he listens to the "still, sad music of humanity," his concern for societal issues is reflected in his works. He denounces modern society's apathy and indifference, as well as discrimination based on race and gender. The interaction between man and society is a major theme in Khushwant Singh's books. Despite being mostly journalistic, Khushwant Singh's writings will undoubtedly endure. He is both an insider and an outsider among Indian English novelists. He has an objectivity that is uncommon among Indian English novelists because of his position. He has been able to combine fact and fiction by using this objectivity in his manner. His fiction is all true. There is a fictitious element to all of his factual articles.

Khushwant Singh is a writer of value because of his clear writing style, deft endings, and sense of humor, which subtly conceals the harsh reality. As he says, he is first and foremost an Indian and then an internationalist. He has a complex personality. If one truly wishes to gauge his abilities and accomplishments, he must be closely examined. The study makes it clear that Singh's novels show a profound concern for societal issues. Disturbed by the profound sense of alienation in today's environment, Khushwant Singh uses his novels to pursue partnerships. He aims to approximate life into art because he believes that life and art are inextricably linked. Although Singh's art and ideas have been the subject of nearly endless critical writing, the author undoubtedly encourages another in-depth reevaluation of his outstanding fictional work. The current investigation is an attempt in this direction, and the researcher aims to add to Khushwant Singh's critique.

Singh has demonstrated that he is a dedicated writer on a cause and has never supported writing only for its own sake. He develops a kind of humanism toward society since he is concerned in the state of humanity. Khushwant Singh is driven to ridicule the absurdities and vices of human civilization because of his concern, love for society, love for integrity, and finally, love for peace and happiness. He creates a number of societal cross sections and concentrates on all the differences. As a result, he includes characters from all walks of life in his stories, and he never leaves one out. With an eagle's vision, he observes society and identifies even the smallest and most basic human fault that needs reformation. He parodies both common and distinguished men. His thoughts were influenced by both Indian and Western traditions. He was shaped by the western education he got in India and England, despite having strong roots in the land and his own culture. His essays demonstrate a harmonious fusion of liberal humanism and scientific rationality.

Khushwant Singh is a humanist and rationalist, hence his satires fluctuate in intensity depending on how important reformation is. He might be nice and gentle at times or harsh and powerful at others. His approach is neither biased nor too empathetic. He expresses his innermost thoughts without fear of the repercussions. He discusses things in a very realistic way that others might be reluctant to disclose. Therefore, "controversial" is the only word that can be used to describe Khushwant Singh. Khushwant Singh's satire targets a variety of persons and behaviors, including those of corrupt politicians, evil men, lustful women, superstitious people, hypocrites, flatterers, religiously insane men, false godmen, sex, infidelity, exploitation, and others. Singh has addressed these elements since he has personally experienced and seen them. Singh based many of the characters in his works on his personal experiences, including friends, family, acquaintances, and strangers he saw.

The presence of satirical aspects in the five books selected for study—*Train to Pakistan*, *I Shall Not Hear the Nightingale*, *Delhi: A Novel*, *The Company of Women*, and *Burial at Sea*—has been carefully examined. A review of satire as a unique literary genre is presented in the first chapter. Its definition, history, causes, importance, and final outcomes are all covered. It's interesting to note that Khushwant Singh had no ambition of becoming a full-time writer. It was only after he discovered anything interesting to write that he decided to write. The chance arose during

the division. The horrific events of those tumultuous days really affected him. His perspective on life drastically changed. He was completely demoralized by the state of affairs now. As it was, his belief in the inherent dignity of people was totally upended: The convictions I had held dear throughout my life were shattered. I had thought that the average person was inherently decent. However, the most brutal atrocities in India's history had occurred concurrently with the country's split. While the rest of the world was focused on pursuing material possessions, I had thought that Indians were peaceful and non-violent people who cared more about spiritual problems. Following the events of the fall of 1947, I was no longer able to support these opinions.

I turned into a middle-aged man who was furious and wanted to express how disillusioned he was with the world. I made the decision to give writing a go. Khushwant Singh was present throughout the Holocaust that ensued when the nation was divided. It was undoubtedly one of the deadliest revolutions in history, resulting in the destruction of property and the deaths of countless innocent people. Khushwant Singh became agitated after the horrific event and turned to writing as a way to express his emotions. As a result, he traveled to Pakistan via train.

Love and sex are two of Khushwant Singh's favorite topics to write about. He has written extensively about the feelings of passion and love. What precisely is this "love" phenomenon? Extreme loneliness is the fundamental factor that drives us to look for another person's love. The sense of being alone in this world is what he refers to as inner solitude. People who only fall in love once in their lives are uncommon. According to Khushwant Singh, sex is more significant in a man's life. According to him, everyone needs sex. There is something unique, lovely, and shared about it. Actually, the foundation of all partnerships is sex. In his book *The Company of Women*, he makes sex the main topic. He exposes sex-related cant, hypocrisy, double standards, and pomposity. Although he places a lot of emphasis on spiritual love, he has the audacity to say that physical love is just as significant. He is adamant that there can never be any intimacy of soul without physical connection. He believes that lust is the real basis of a man-woman connection since, in contrast to love; it is not mysterious or subject to varying interpretations.

Khushwant Singh parodies all the moral and religious taboos and social respectability codes that are imposed on people in modern Indian society through his voyeuristic depiction of sex and sexploitation, as well as his titillating accounts of the countless sexual encounters. Thus, the crafty old guy of Indian English fiction may be enjoying a final chuckle at the pomposity and sanctimonious morals of middle class India by deftly portraying and emphasizing manly fantasies about alluring women. Extreme reactions have always been evoked by his works. *The Company of Women* is a book that follows that pattern. Therefore, Khushwant Singh's goal for this book may be to expose the moral hypocrisy and middle class morals. Shiela Reddy has aptly referred to it in her book review. "The Truth about a Dirty Old Society."

Singh believes that politicians are the primary target of all societal issues. He attacks politicians that prioritize corruption. He criticizes such politicians in every one of his

novels. Perhaps it's because he was a politician himself and would have observed or learned of all their wrongdoings. Singh's first book to depict the terrible times of the Partition era truthfully is *Train to Pakistan*. "The partition theme," says Khushwant Singh, "was born out of a sense of guilt that I had done nothing to save the lives of innocent people and behaved like a coward." He later carried a persistent sense of shame for betraying both his country and his fellow citizens. There is no denying that politicians were the primary cause of Pakistan's separation from India. Singh makes remarks about politicians who make promises and speak the truth, but they never take that stance after their work is done. One of the author's outstanding similes is the crane standing on one leg, grubbing its food (fish) as soon as it appears, like a yogi performing penance. Singh makes fun of the politicians for their lack of vision.

The leaders' poor decision-making and lack of vision turned the most joyous occasion into the deadliest period in Indian history. Singh sheds light on Buta Singh and his son Sher Singh in *I Shall Not Hear the Nightingale*, despite the fact that the politicians are not specifically attacked. Due to his lack of sex skills, Buta Singh is egotistical and devoted to the British Raj and Sher Singh, the aspiring politician, who is more interested in politics. His goals were lofty. He was constantly surrounded by individuals who were applauding him in the idyllic world of politics. Since he was constantly stuck in a bind, he doesn't deserve it. He lacked the bravery as well. When Taylor, the Deputy Commissioner, finally lets him go, he plans a lavish celebration to mark his triumph. Delhi, the third book, is full with glaringly caustic comments against the politicians.

Singh challenges higher-ranking figures like Gandhiji and Nehru in his criticism of politicians. Singh, a supporter of humanism and peace, accuses them of being involved in the Partition. He accuses Nehru and Gandhiji of being hypocritical and gives the impression that they backed the Pakistanis. They lacked foresight and were more focused on their own personal growth. He also expresses his disdain for Indira Gandhi in the same book, claiming that she was the root of the Golden Temple controversy. He claims she set the entire house on fire in order to kill a mouse. In an interview, he claims that despite not being a religious believer, he felt a sense of community and religious affiliation. Politicians are not a major topic in *The Company of Women*, but they are in his final book, *Burial at Sea*. The Congress members approach Victor, who has worked hard to become one of India's business tycoons, and try to get him involved in politics, but Victor obstinately declines.

Singh reveals the crooked, self-serving attitude of politicians through one of his characters, Nair. With Victor's help, Nair joins the political sphere, but rather than being true and loyal, Nair begins to stab Victor in the back. He first embezzles money using commissions from the shipping industry before luring Victor's daughter Bharati. When he later enters politics, he publicly attacks Victor using a variety of tactics and ultimately bears responsibility for his benefactor's passing. In addition, Singh makes fun of the politicians' different practices, such as posing for pictures with wealthy and well-known people and robbing businessmen of their money in the name of charity and donations. Khushwant Singh's next area of interest is sex and love. Different approaches are taken while discussing love and sex, including its various stages and forms, as well

as its causes and effects. He is adamant that love cannot exist without passion and that lust renders love profane.

The main character in *Train to Pakistan*, "Juggut Singh," is portrayed as a badass, rogue, dishonest, and obnoxious fool. Singh realistically emphasizes that sex is a component of pure love and that it is the goal of true love. He criticizes others' unfavorable views of love and demonstrates how caste and religion are major factors in men's resistance to it. purely towards the end of the book do we realize that the love between Juggut Singh and Nooran, the Muslim weaver's daughter, is pure, despite the fact that it appears to be based purely on sexual attraction. However, the dishonest guy gives his life to save Nooran when he learns that she is carrying his child in her womb and that she must ride in the train that the rioters were going to destroy. The real meaning of love can be found here.

In the same book, a highly educated, respected, and respectable magistrate named Hukum Chand has sex with a young prostitute named Haseena, who is old enough to be his daughter, while intoxicated. Here, too, Hukum Chand releases Juggut, who saves the train, out of desire that eventually turns into love. The notion that lust results in love is still present in *I Shall Not Hear the Nightingale*. This highlights Champak's unethical nature as an exhibitionist. After her husband Sher Singh fails to provide her with the sex she expects, she starts seeing Madan, a handsome cricket player. Here, Singh highlights the immorality of both men and women in the community. Madan and Champak are not loyal to their counterparts. Singh draws attention to the prevalence of these illegal and immoral activities in urban culture. There is love and passion in every chapter of the book *Delhi*. They are both handled differently. There is only sex in the Bhagmati and narrator episodes.

A hijda named Bhagmati enters the narrator's life and, despite her sporadic appearances, remains with the author until the book's conclusion. The eunuch, Bhagmati, is a representation of sterility. The narrator and Bhagmati's relationship starts and ends with lust, but when she saves the narrator that lust ultimately transforms into love. Singh addresses conjugal love in the Mussadi Lai episode. The author cautions the children in the Meer Taqi Meer tale to avoid coquettes in general. Singh also makes fun of males who support such shady, filthy ladies while having a wonderful wife and family. Sex is handled differently in the Alice Aldwell episode. To assist her land her husband a job in Delhi, Alice first has sex with her boss, Mr. George Atkins. She soon gives birth to a daughter, whom she names Georgina. Singh exposes these illegal relationships that are common in society.

Later, Mirza Abdullah and two of his friends rape the same Alice. None of the powerful monarchs were devoid of women. in *The Company of Women*. Singh arouses the sexual desire that exists in both sexes. He makes fun of morally bankrupt men and women. After being separated from Sonu, the main character, Mohan Kumar, a foreign immigrant, begins pursuing a string of women. Each woman comes from two distinct social backgrounds. The book appears to be a list of the ladies who surrender to Mohan. Singh illustrates how many women seem to be chaste but are actually prepared to accept an offer in secret. Sarojini Bharadwaj, an English professor from an orthodox Brahmin community, Susanthika from the High Commission of Sri Lanka, and the sweeper woman Dhanno all become Mohan's mistresses.

Thus, the author illustrates how the urban elite waste their time on unimportant things. Consumption alone is a manifestation of modernization; civic awareness and respect for one another are not. When Mohan Kumar passes away from HIV, the relationship's outcome is lethal. Every character in *Burial at Sea* engages in sexual activity, with the exception of Victor's mother and wife. Victor's father, Mattoo, and the governess, Valerie, get along well. Victor becomes a victim of Durgeshwari's lusty world after losing his virginity to an English prostitute. Nair, Victor's best friend and philosopher, seduces Bharati, who is then enchanted by the yoga instructor once more. Khushwant Singh's satire targets the upper and upper-middle classes in connection to these relationships.

He mostly accomplishes this since he was a member of the upper middle class himself and had close ties to them while working as a politician. Khushwant Singh goes on to discuss the importance of family ties. As a sentimental man, he placed greater value on relationships. In *Train to Pakistan*, Jugga gives his life once more in order to protect his Nooran and his unborn child. In *I Shall Not Hear the Nightingale*, Sabhrai gives her life in order to protect her family. A simple old woman in Delhi causes individuals like Meer to end their relationship. Despite his fame and fortune, Mohan Kumar in *The Company of Women* loses his wife and his lovely children. At sea, in *burial*. After betraying Victor, Nair loses his friendship. Betrayal is the most notable topic Khushwant Singh parodies. The author gives this phrase more weight because he has encountered numerous examples and learned a lot from his own experience. Victor, a businessman, is deceived by his friend Nair.

Burial at Sea is where Mattoo betrays his wife. The *Nightingale* in *I Shall Not Hear Her*. Madan betrays his wife in Delhi, and Champak betrays Sher Singh. The rulers turn on one another, and Meer Taqi betrays his wife, who is betrayed by Sahiba Begum. Mahatma Gandhiji is betrayed by his own countrymen, Aurangzeb betrays his father and brothers, and Indira Gandhi is betrayed by her own Sikh bodyguard. Singh had highlighted real-life events and revealed the crafty side of humanity in order to curb this kind of mindset. As a humanist, Singh enjoys life's joys and frolics. He believed that his people loved peace, but after seeing how cruel and barbaric humans could be during the Holocaust of the Partition, he lost faith in them. Singh's mockery of this human beast is there in all five of the works. The clearest illustration to support this claim is the train to Pakistan. India's history was wracked by the Partition. The portrayal of Muslims murdering Sikhs and Hindus in Pakistan and Sikhs slaughtering Muslims and putting their bodies in trains is extremely realistic and violent. Many Indians did not anticipate the ruthless kidnapping of women, the murder of defenseless children, or the plundering of homes and property. The idea of Partition was introduced by politicians for their own reputation and personal gain. Numerous episodes in the book *Delhi* reveal the barbaric essence of humanity.

All of the Mughal emperors, with the exception of Bahadur Shah Zafar, had this trait. Under the garb of religion, emperors such as Taimurs, Aurangzeb, and Nadir Shah arrived in India with personal ambitions. These tyrants gave their forces orders to burn down every Hindu and Sikh household, murder every man, woman, and kid, and level every house. They exploited the entire nation, dug up their homes, and stripped women bare. The terrorist group's

murder of a Muslim shopkeeper, disruption of national harmony, and eventual assassination of the weak Indira Gandhi are all examples of the barbaric essence of humanity in the episodes labeled *The Builders* and *The Dispossessed*. Even in the book *Burial at Sea*, Nair, Victor's companion is held accountable for the death of the largest billionaire in India. Singh is adamantly against these negative practices. In all of his stories, Singh also makes fun of the belief in superstition. In this regard, he specifically criticizes Indians. Singh is a rationalist and an atheist. He mocks men's foolishness with regard to superstition, but not harshly. When describing the village of Mano Majra and its inhabitants at the outset of *Train to Pakistan*, the author mentions a three-foot slab of sandstone beneath a Keekar tree, which served as the local deity, and claims that the Hindus, Sikhs, Muslims, or pseudo-Christians "repair secretly whenever they are in special need of blessing." Singh criticizes their hypocrisy in addition to their convictions. *The Nightingale* in *I Shall Not Hear Her*. At the start of the book, Sher Singh and his friends discuss "baptism in blood," referring to the ancient Hindu religious practice of dipping swords in the blood of goat sacrifices and presenting them to the Goddess "Kali" or "Durga." Superstition is prevalent in Delhi, a book on religious intolerance. The author presents the occurrence of a severe sandstorm, famine, confusion, and poverty as a result of Khwaja Sahib's prophecies and blessings for everyone, as well as the appearance of another dervish who plots against the king and ultimately meets a fatal end. This is done in order to expose the crafty nature and ugly minds of such soothsayers.

Superstition can be somewhat tolerated if it is held by common people, but powerful Mughal monarchs like Shah Jahan, Nadir Shah, and Aurangzeb all had this belief. Shah Jahan rejects Aurangzeb as his heir after listening to soothsayers and gossipers. After having a dream about driving the birds off a property, the Taimurs go to a saint to have their dream explained. The saint claims that, much as they had driven the binds from a farm in the dream, he (Taimur) would drive them out of the area where the infidels reside in great numbers. As a result, the Taimurs only go to Delhi to take advantage of it. Superstitious satire can also be found in *The Company of Women*. Mohan's father informs him about the cleanliness and confidence that people have in the Haridwar and the Ganga when he takes him there. He claims that the water lost its purity once it was put down and that it is revered as a goddess who, in a single dip, took away all of humanity's sins.

Mohan, who shares Singh's rationalist views, responds to Singh's attacks on men like his father. By telling his father that the pure water was tainted and polluted by bodies dumped into it and rituals, Mohan explains to him that it was all superstition. The author of *Burial at Sea* discusses false religion and irrational notions. Superstitious people are easy targets for men and women who deceive in the name of religion. Victor succumbs to Ma Durgeshwari's alluring beauty. He donates his hard-earned cash to charitable causes. It was later established that Durgeshwari's true name was Shanti Devi and that she had dated three men before becoming a sadhvi, all of whom abandoned her. Durga Das, the yoga instructor Swami Dhananjay Brahmachari, was found guilty of burglary and theft. Khushwant Singh is also troubled by the practice of introducing young people to sex. This feature appears in all of Singh's books. The same thing

would have happened to him personally if he had pursued his further education in England.

Singh vehemently criticizes adults who encourage children to engage in sexual activity, a prevalent problem in today's society. Haseena is forced into sexual orgies by the magistrate in *Train to Pakistan* Hukum Chand. Fortunately, Beena barely avoids being forced into sexual relations by Madan in *I Shall Not Hear the Nightingale* when she witnesses Champak leaving Madan's Simla chamber. Begum Sahiba, Nawab Rais's wife, introduces the young poet Taqi to the realm of love in Delhi.

The author recounts another occasion in which he reads in the papers that a small boy was raped by his stepmother while his father was on tour. Sue and Molly Gomes both had flashbacks to their deflowering experiences in *The Company of Women*. The younger brother of her mother wooed Molly, while the younger brother of her father wooed Susanthika. She seduces his fourteen-year-old son in exchange. Here, Singh exposes the absence of morals in modern culture in addition to mocking those who encourage young people to engage in sexual activity. At sea, in burial. A prostitute causes Victor to lose his virginity, and Nair seduces his daughter Bharati in the same location where her father lost his. Singh tackles the majority of society's ills in his works.

This group includes Hukum Chand and the police inspector in *Train to Pakistan*. Although the inspector performs his duties with great sincerity, the magistrate occasionally makes fun of him. Therefore, the inspector flatters Hukum Chand in order to get things done. The magistrate and inspector just wanted to take any action that wouldn't lead to issues. They didn't care about other people at all. This demonstrates how self-centered both are. Hukum Chand appears to be in charge and takes a brave stance outside, yet he is not.

7. Further Scope of the Study

The importance of particular components, such as satire, and its significance in Khushwant Singh's chosen books are the main topics of the current study, *The Portrayal of Satire in the Selected books of Khushwant Singh: A Critical Study*. Scholars can, however, investigate a number of topics, such as his stylistic devices and the influence of his writing on Indian literature and society. The pragmatic analysis of his language can also be studied.

8. Conclusion

Studying Khushwant Singh's best-known novels gives pupils a better understanding of Indian customs and culture. Students learn more about Indian literature in the form of fiction thanks to this self-study. The study's concluding remarks will accentuate the broad appeal of his novels and his effective use of satire to address relevant issues of contemporary society. Students also learn how to style his style and narrative approaches in all of his major novels in detail, in addition to developing their unique language talents, which are enduring and charming in their academic career.

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